YARA RULE CREATION AND DETECTION REPORT

WEEK 2 (Day 5)

Prepared By: Prince Emmanuel Okezie

Date: 2026-05-14

Objective

The purpose of this exercise was to create and test a YARA rule capable of detecting specific DarkSide ransomware-related strings within a text file.

YARA Rule Used

```
rule detect_darkside
 {
 meta:
 author = "Remilekun Olakunle"
 description = "Detects DarkSide malware strings"
 date = "2025-10-15"

 strings:
 $text1 = "DarkSide"
 $text2 = "actor"
 $text3 = "cybercriminal"

 condition:
 all of them
 }
```

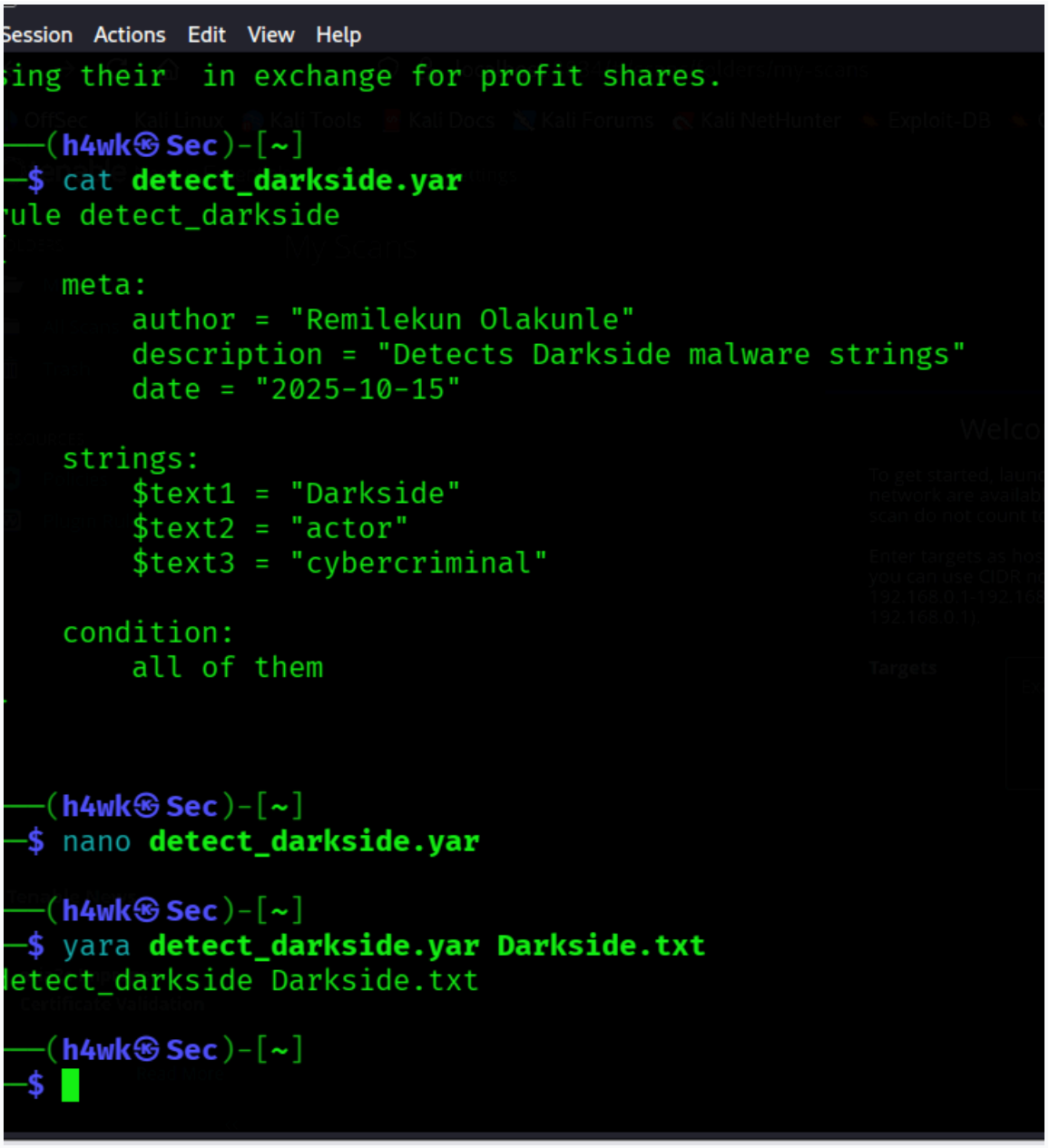
Testing Procedure

1. Created a YARA rule file named detect_darkside.yar.
2. Created a sample text file named Darkside.txt.
3. Executed the YARA scan command:
yara detect_darkside.yar Darkside.txt
4. Verified that the rule successfully matched the file.

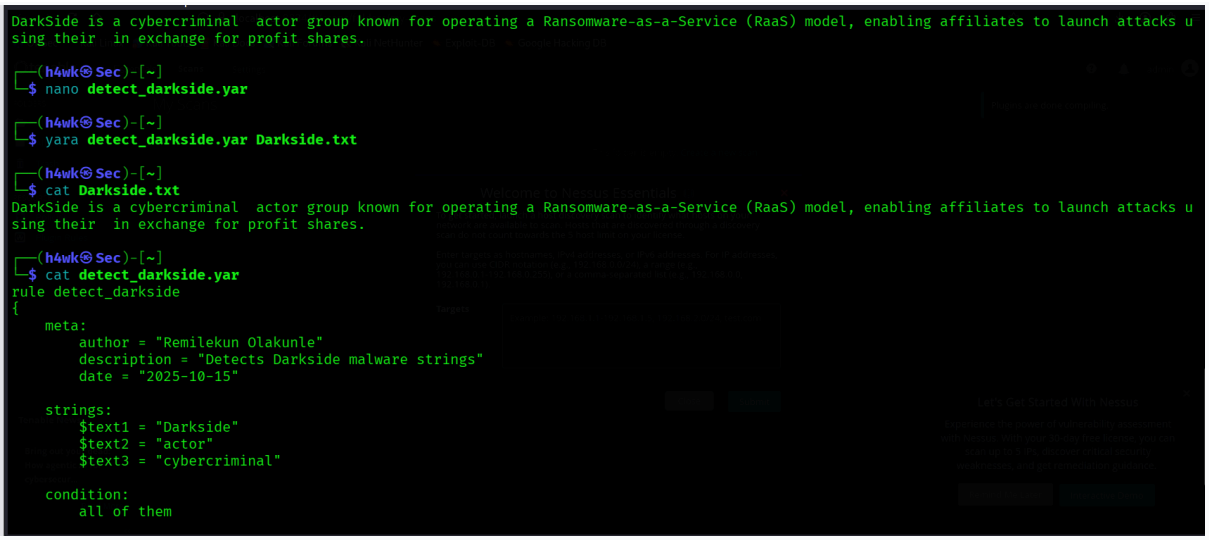
Scan Result

The output confirmed that the file matched the YARA rule, indicating successful detection of the specified DarkSide-related strings.

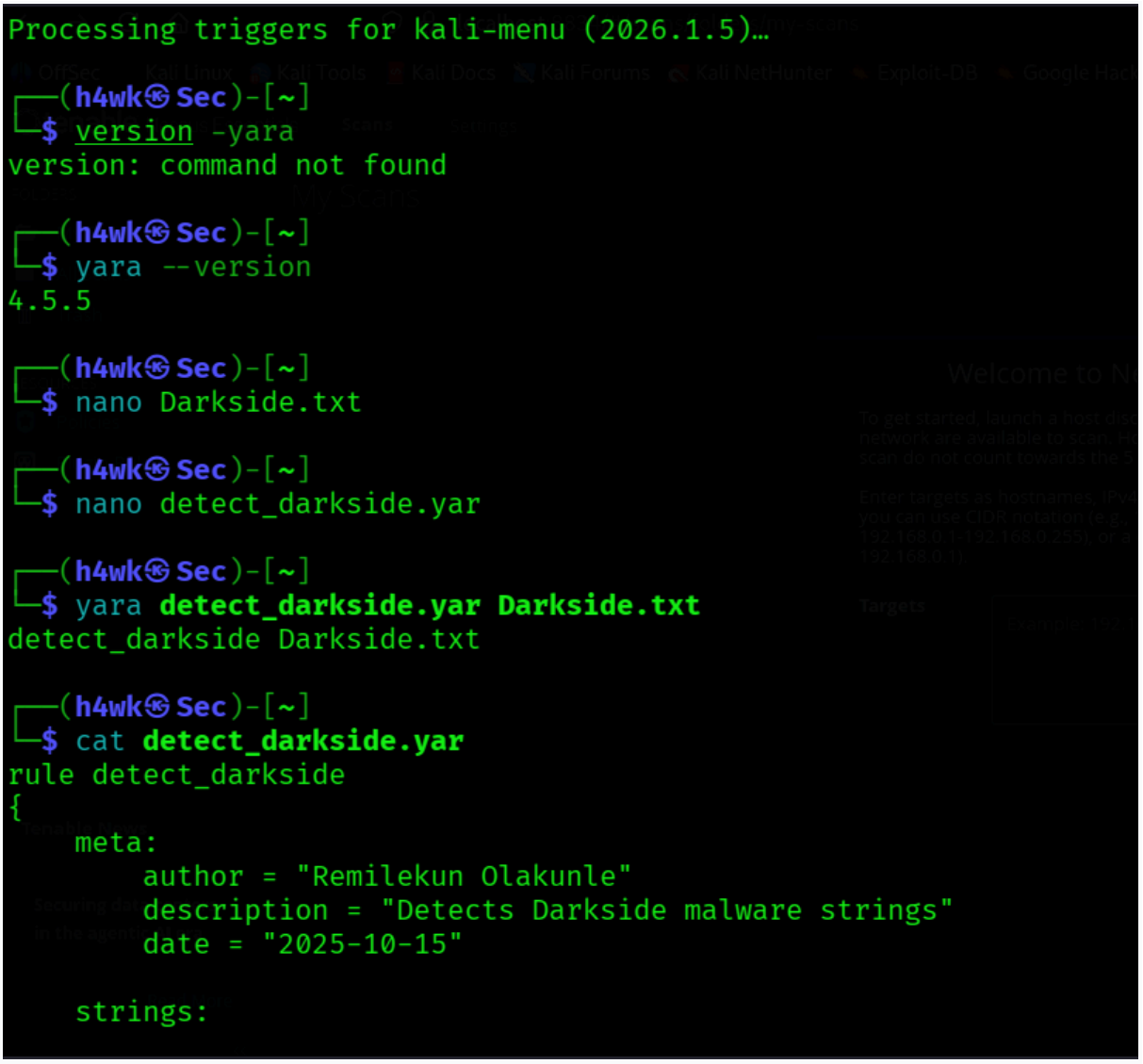
Screenshot 1



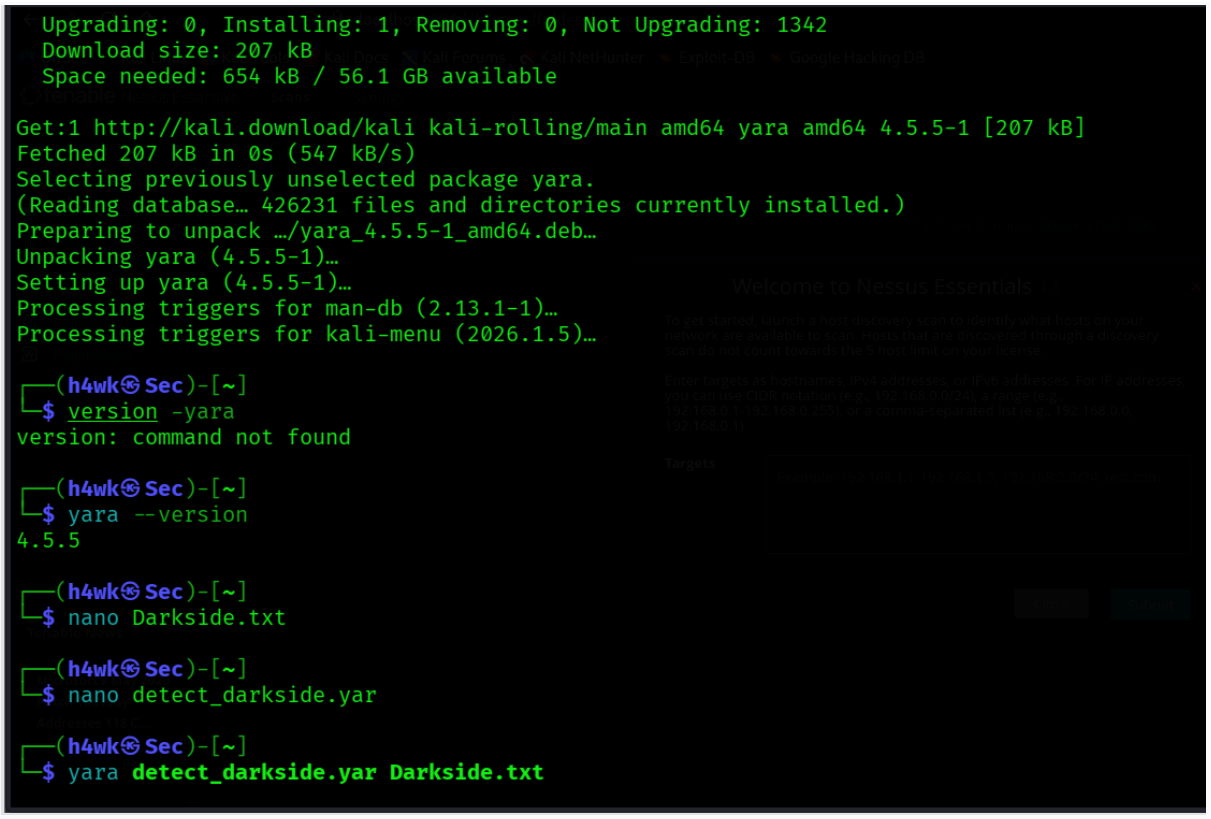
Screenshot 2



Screenshot 3



Screenshot 4



Conclusion

The YARA rule was successfully created and tested. The scan demonstrated that YARA can identify files containing predefined malware-related indicators. This approach can be expanded with more advanced indicators such as byte patterns, mutex names, ransom notes, and PE file characteristics for improved malware detection.